

DISCANTUS

Plau - de eu - ge the - o - to - cos

MEDIUS

Plau - de eu - ge the - o - to - cos

TENOR

Plau - de the - o - to - cos

D. sa - lus ho - mi - num in te con - fi - den - ci -

M. — sa - lus ho - mi - num in te con - fi - den - ci -

T. sa - - - lus con - fi - den - ci -

1. 2.

D. um con-fi-den-ci-um um con-fi-den-ci-um

M. um con-fi-den-ci-um um con-fi-den-ci-um

T. um con-fi-den-ci-um um con-fi-den-ci-um

20

D. Te lau - dan - tes in - spi - ce mi - se - ros

M. Te lau - dan - tes in - spi - ce

T. Te lau - dan - tes in - spi - ce

25

D. nec de - spi - ce

M. mi - se - ros nec de - spi - ce

T. nec de - spi - ce

28

D. sed mi - se - ri - cor - di - e o - cu -

M. sed mi - se - ri - cor - di - e o - cu -

T. sed hos o - cu -

31

1. lis hos re - spi - ce

2. lis hos re - spi - ce

M. lis hos re - spi - ce

T. lis re - spi - ce

TEXT AND TRANSLATION

Plaude, euge, theotocos,
regina virginum,
salus hominum
in te confidencium.

Te laudantes inspice,
miseros nec despice,
sed misericordie
oculis hos respice.

*Rejoice, well done, Mother of God,
queen of virgins,
salvation of all
who trust in you.*

*Look upon those who praise you,
do not despise the wretched,
but look on them
with the eyes of mercy.*

FOR REHEARSAL

The song. Piotr z Grudziądza (1392 – after 1452) studied and graduated at Kraków and later served as a chaplain at the court of Frederick III. His songs travelled widely in central Europe, and he signed many of them with an acrostic. Here the initials of the opening words spell PETRVS. He wrote the poem himself. It greets the Virgin as *theotocos*, the Greek ‘God-bearer’ (the word that Polish *Bogurodzica* translates), and then asks her to look on her singers with the eyes of mercy, in words close to the *Salve Regina*. For the sounds of the Latin, see the series pronunciation guide.

Voices and pitch. The piece survives in one manuscript, Leipzig, Universitätsbibliothek, Ms 1236, copied in 1447–9. The voices are the source’s own: Discantus, Medius and Tenor. At the printed pitch they suit alto, tenor and bass. The source writes no clefs, so the pitch and the key signature are editorial. Piotr’s songs were sung by students and clerics, often three men of similar range, and an all-male group may transpose the piece down to suit.

The Tenor. The Tenor has no text in the source and may be played (a fiddle or organ suits it), vocalised, or sung. Its text here is editorial, printed in italics, and shortened on purpose. The Tenor keeps its long notes and sings only the words that fit, while the upper voices carry the whole poem. Dashed ties mark the places in the endings where a note of the source is divided. In the first part the Tenor takes the two endings differently. The first time it anticipates *con-fi*; the second time it moves with the upper voices. Small accidentals above the staff are editorial. The two sharps in the final cadence belong together, so sing both or neither. The note in square brackets at the end of each second ending is hidden in the binding of the manuscript; it is printed as a long, like the other voices’ final notes.

The score. Note values are those of the source. Lines between the staves mark each breve and are not bar lines in the modern sense. Each half of the song is sung twice, with the first ending and then the second. The long at the end of an ending is held until all voices have finished. Lines 3–4 of the second half are best sung as a block, all voices declaiming together.